Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Meaning, nature, scope and relevance of Political Theory

Introduction to Political Theory · Unit 1 · Chapter Meaning, nature, scope and relevance of Political Theory

Assam University · BA FYUGP / NEP 2020 · Semester 1

Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

Political Theory analyses concepts such as liberty, equality, justice, rights, authority and democracy. It asks what political arrangements exist and what arrangements are justified.

1. Its nature is both analytical and normative: it clarifies meanings, examines evidence and evaluates institutions using arguments and values.

2. Its scope includes the state, citizenship, political obligation, rights, democracy, justice, power, representation and contemporary debates.

3. Political Theory helps citizens evaluate public policy, challenge unjustified power, clarify disagreements and reason carefully about competing political values.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?